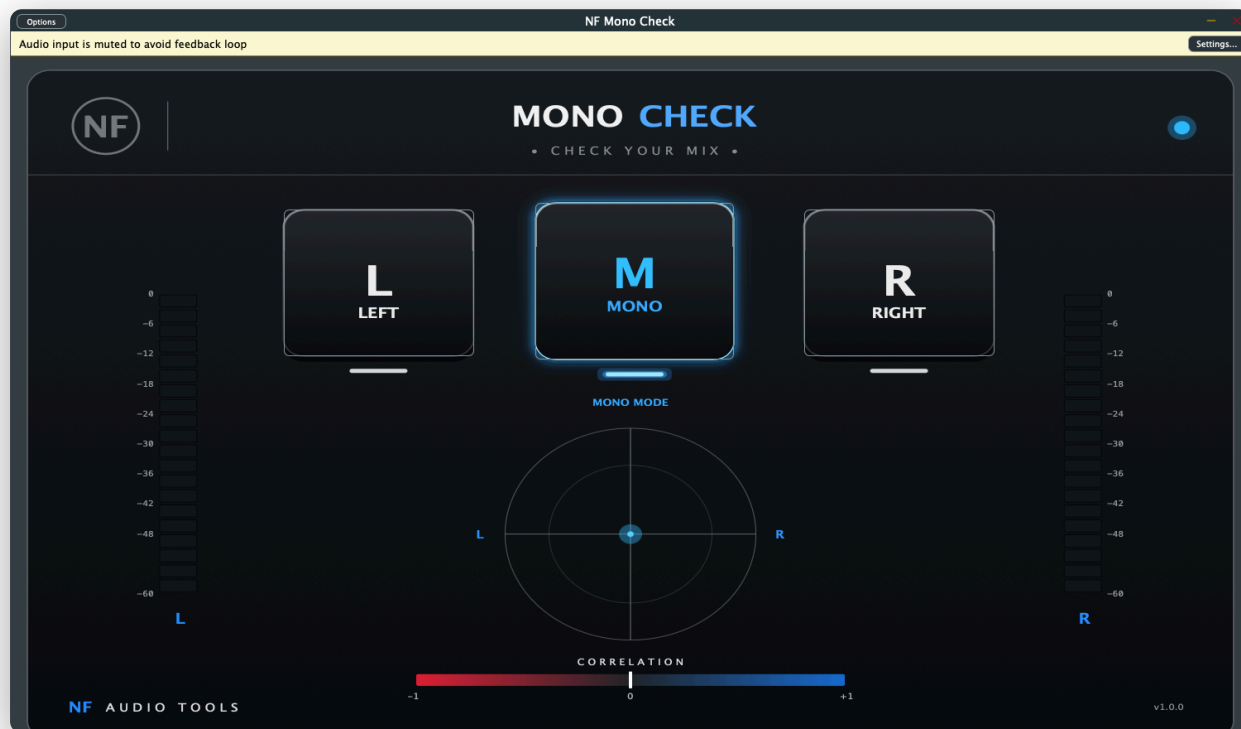




NF MONO CHECK

MONO / STEREO COMPATIBILITY MONITOR — USER MANUAL

Version 1.0.0 · NF Audio Tools · VST3 / AU / Standalone

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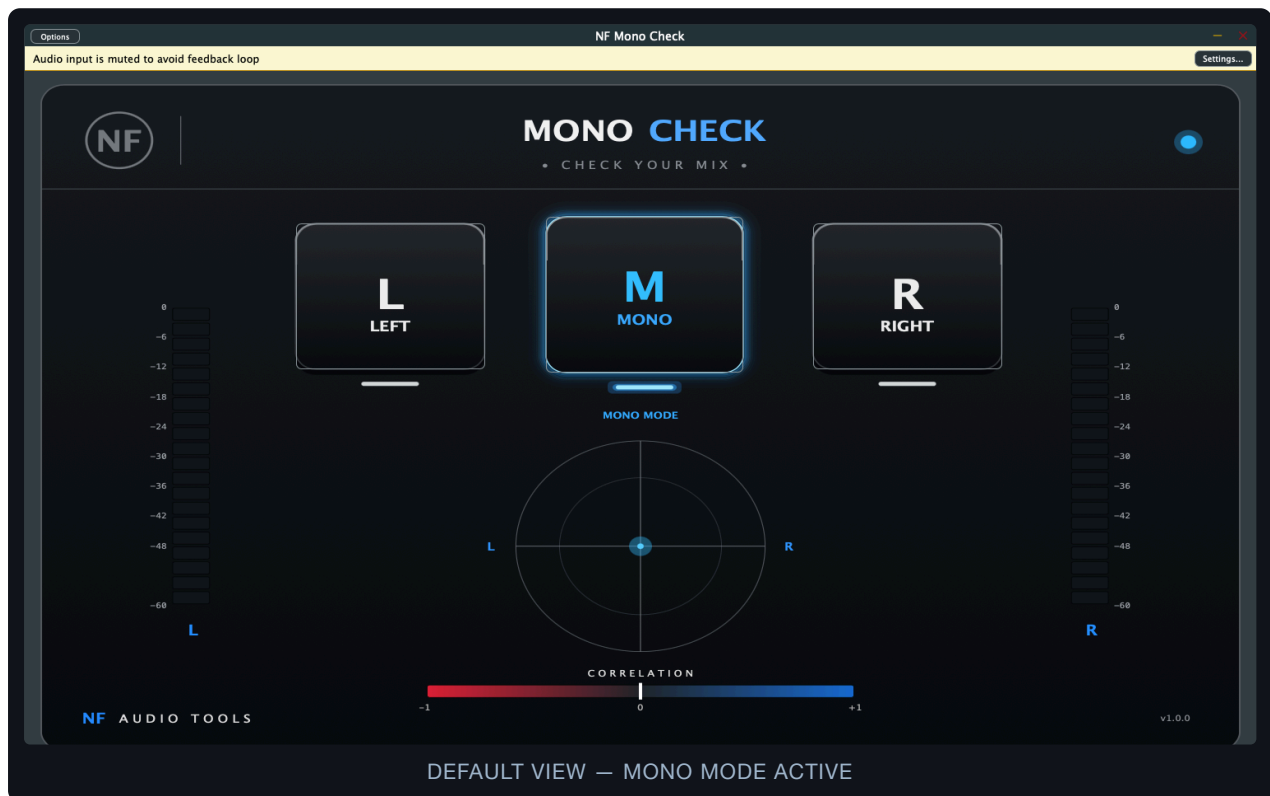
Contents

1. Overview
2. Installation
3. Interface Guide
4. L / M / R / Stereo Modes
5. Correlation Meter & Goniometer
6. Window & Resizing
7. Automation & Parameters
8. Usage Tips
9. Credits & Version

1. Overview

NF Mono Check is a monitoring utility for the master bus. It switches the way you listen to a stereo mix — Left only, Right only, true Mono, or unprocessed Stereo — without altering the signal being sent onward, so you can catch mono-compatibility problems, phase cancellation, polarity issues and stereo-width problems before they leave the studio.

A live correlation meter and a real-time goniometer (vectorscope), both driven from the original, unprocessed stereo signal, give you a constant visual read on how correlated your left and right channels are — regardless of which monitoring mode is currently selected.



2. Installation

macOS

1. Open `NF Mono Check – Mac Installer.dmg` .
2. Double-click `NF Mono Check Installer.pkg` and follow the prompts.
3. The installer places the plugin in:
 - `/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3/NF Mono Check.vst3`
 - `/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components/NF Mono Check.component` (Audio Unit)
4. Rescan plugins in your DAW if it doesn't appear automatically.

Windows

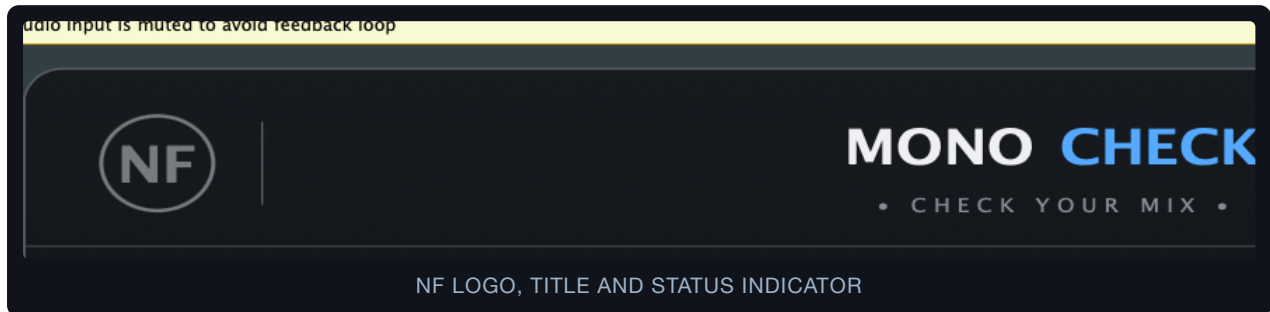
1. Run `NF Mono Check Installer.exe` .
2. The installer places the VST3 in `C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3\NF Mono Check.vst3` , and the PDF manuals (English + Portuguese) in `C:\Program Files\NF Audio Tools\NF Mono Check\Manual\` .
3. Rescan plugins in your DAW if it doesn't appear automatically.

An uninstaller is included on both platforms (macOS: re-run the package and choose remove where offered; Windows: "Uninstall NF Mono Check" from Control Panel / Apps). The bilingual PDF manual is installed by both installers — on macOS into `/Users/Shared/NF Audio Tools/NF Mono Check/Manual` .

3. Interface Guide

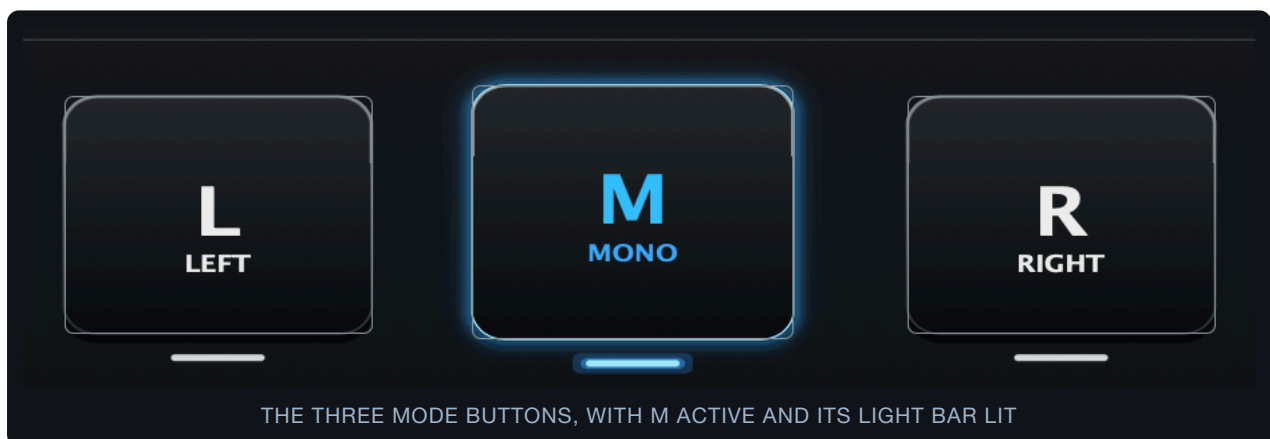
Every element on the panel is described below, in the order it appears from top to bottom.

Logo & Title Bar



The NF roundel at the top-left identifies the manufacturer. **Double-clicking it resets the plugin window to its default size** — handy after dragging the resize corner to make the window larger. The blue dot at the top-right is a status indicator.

L / M / R Mode Buttons



These three buttons select what you hear. A thin light bar beneath each button lights up blue when that button's mode is engaged, mirroring the button's own glow. See the full Modes chapter below for exactly what each one does to the signal.

Level Meters (L / R)



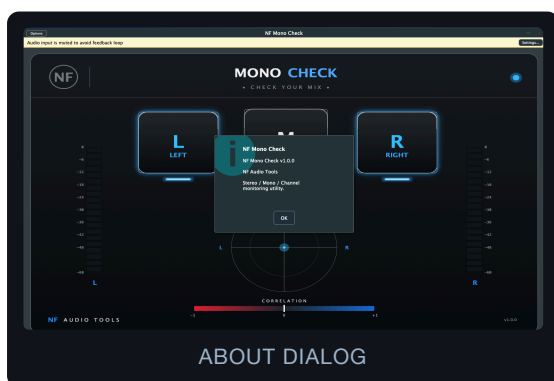
The two vertical meters at the left and right edges of the panel always show the level of the **original, unprocessed** input signal — Input L on the left, Input R on the right — regardless of which monitoring mode is selected. This lets you keep an eye on the real mix levels even while auditioning Mono or an isolated channel.

Goniometer (Vectorscope) & Correlation Meter



The circular display is a real-time goniometer, plotting the original stereo signal's Left/Right relationship as a scatter of points: a signal that collapses to a vertical line is highly mono-compatible, while a signal that spreads out horizontally has significant stereo width or phase difference between channels. The horizontal bar beneath it is the correlation meter — see the dedicated chapter below for how to read it.

About Dialog



Click the **“MONO CHECK”** title at the top of the panel to see the plugin's name, version number and manufacturer at a glance.

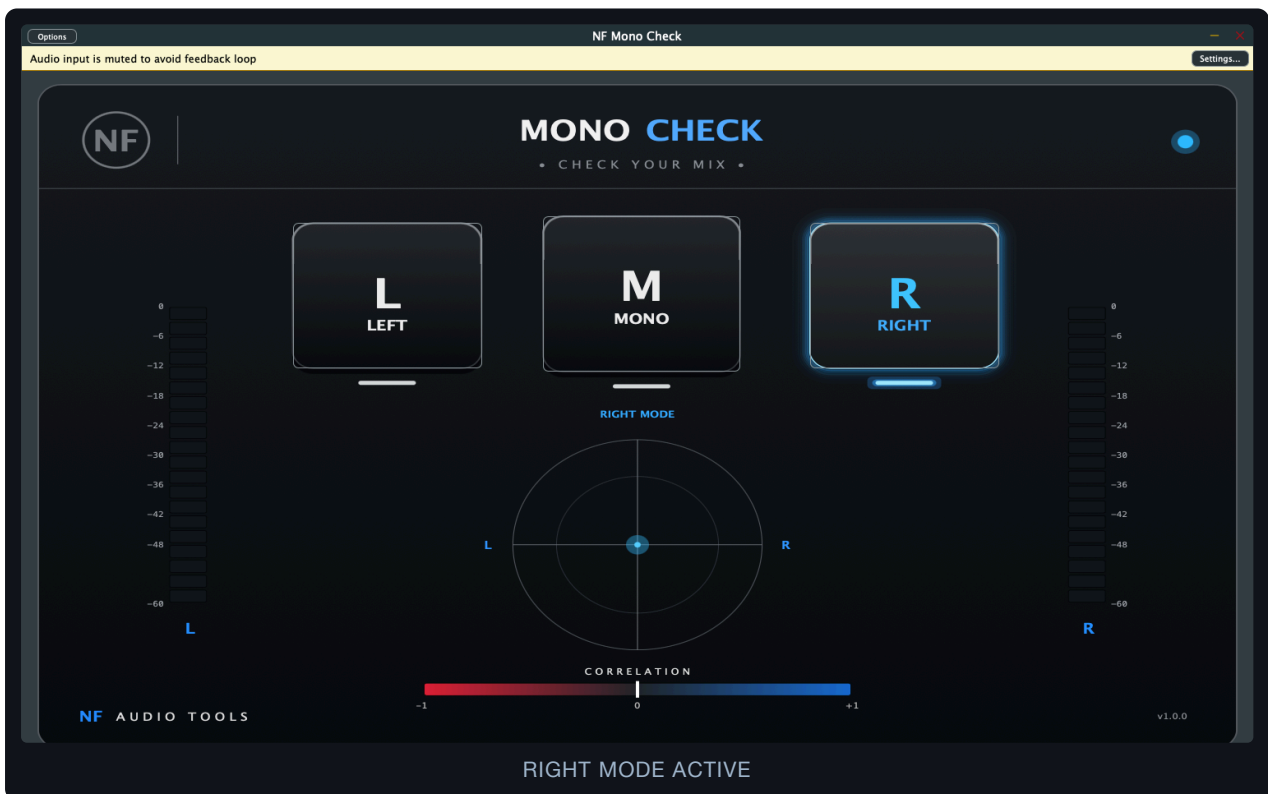
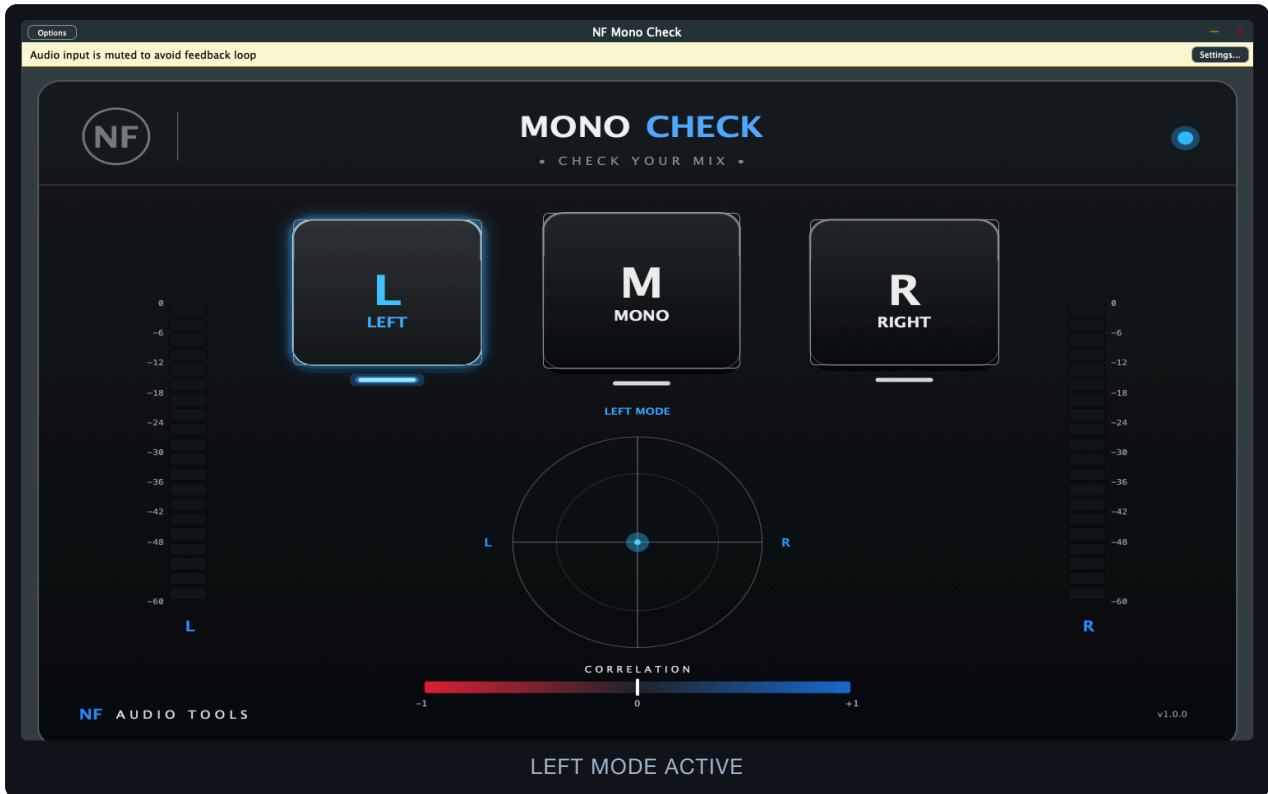
Footer

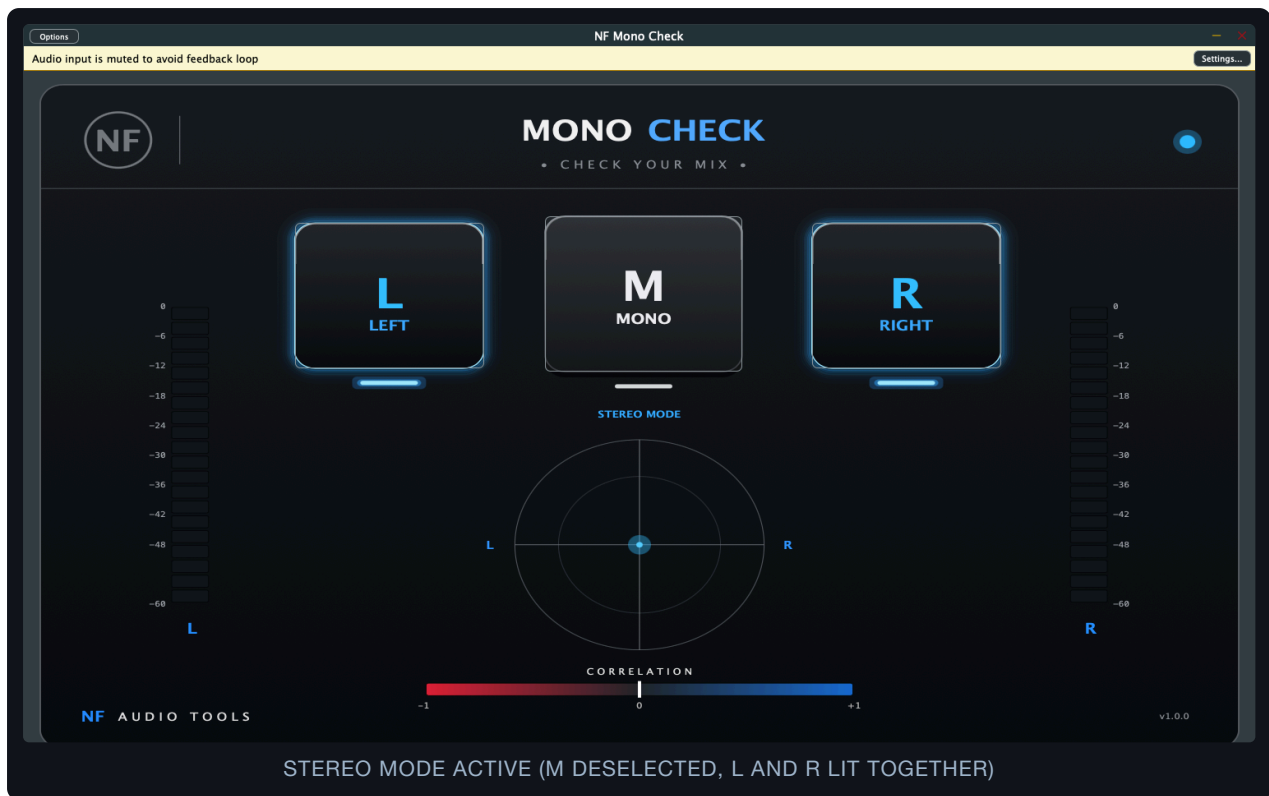


The bottom-left corner shows the NF Audio Tools brand; the bottom-right corner shows the installed plugin version.

4. L / M / R / Stereo Modes

NF Mono Check listens to the same original stereo input at all times for its meters and correlation display, but reroutes what's actually sent to your monitors depending on which mode is selected:





Mode	Output L	Output R	Description
L — LEFT	Input L	silent	Isolates the left channel, hard left — the right side of your monitors goes silent so you hear only what's panned/recorded to the left.
M — MONO	$(L+R) \times 0.5$	$(L+R) \times 0.5$	Sums Left and Right into a single, true-mono signal, played identically on both outputs. This is the primary tool for checking mono compatibility: anything that disappears or thins out here has a phase or polarity problem.
R — RIGHT	silent	Input R	Isolates the right channel, hard right — the left side of your monitors goes silent so you hear only what's panned/recorded to the right.
STEREO (M deselected)	Input L	Input R	Unprocessed passthrough — the original stereo signal, untouched. Reached by clicking M a second time (toggling it off), or by double-clicking L or R while either is active.

Quick toggles: click M again while it's already active to jump straight to Stereo (L and R light up together). Double-clicking an isolated L or R button also returns you to Stereo. Clicking L or R always selects that channel with a single click.

5. Correlation Meter & Goniometer

Both the correlation bar and the goniometer circle are driven by the **original, unprocessed stereo signal** — they keep reporting on your true stereo image even while you're listening in Mono, Left or Right monitoring mode.

Value	Meaning
+1	Fully correlated. Left and Right are identical or very similar — excellent mono compatibility.
0	Low correlation. Left and Right share little in common — typical of wide stereo content; not necessarily a problem, but worth checking in Mono.
-1	Out of phase. Left and Right substantially cancel each other — a real mono-compatibility problem that will lose energy (or disappear) when summed to mono.

As a rule of thumb, a mix that stays mostly in positive territory (the marker sitting to the right of centre) is in good shape for mono playback systems, club systems, TV broadcast, and other environments that sum to mono. Frequent excursions into negative territory are worth investigating with the M button.

The goniometer is a live, real-time display — each dot is an actual audio sample, not a synthetic animation, so what you see always matches what's currently passing through the plugin's input.

6. Window & Resizing

The plugin window can be freely resized by dragging the small handle in the bottom-right corner, from a compact minimum up to a much larger size — the entire interface scales together, so nothing gets cropped or repositioned.



Double-click the NF logo in the top-left corner at any time to instantly snap the window back to its default size.

7. Automation & Parameters

NF Mono Check exposes a single automatable parameter to your DAW:

Parameter	Values	Default
Monitor Mode	Left / Mono / Right / Stereo	Mono

This parameter is saved and recalled with your session, and can be automated like any other plugin parameter in your DAW — useful for, e.g., automatically dropping into Mono for a few bars during a mix review pass.

8. Usage Tips

- Check Mono compatibility early and often during a mix, not just at the end — it's much easier to fix a phase problem on one element than to hunt for it once the whole mix collapses in Mono.
- Watch the correlation meter while adjusting stereo-widening tools, double-tracked parts, or heavily panned elements — sudden dips toward -1 usually point to the change you just made.
- The goniometer's shape is a fast visual gut-check: a tall, narrow vertical shape is safe for mono; a wide, horizontal shape means real stereo-only content that will lose energy when summed.
- Use the L and R isolate modes to confirm channel identity and catch accidental channel swaps, especially after routing or bouncing stems.

9. Credits & Version

NF Mono Check is developed by NF Audio Tools. This manual and the plugin describe version 1.0.0.

Format	Version	Platform
VST3	1.0.0	macOS / Windows
Audio Unit (AU)	1.0.0	macOS
Standalone	1.0.0	macOS

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